Rightsizing Engagement Recap: What We Heard
November 3 - November 9, 2026

Executive Summary

This memo is a summary of public feedback on the proposed rightsizing scenarios. It covers community input gathered between **November 3 - November 9, 2026.**

As of November 3rd, we have received 3,559 responses from parents/guardians, PPS staff, students, and community members representing all of our school communities. About 91% of respondents represented school communities affected by the rightsizing scenario proposals in some way, including school closure, school consolidation, program changes, or boundary changes.

In this What We Heard memo, we present survey data collected to date, including a deep dive into the perspective of staff and families in schools identified as receiving schools in the rightsizing scenarios.

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Introduction

Every Monday, from when the rightsizing plans were released on October 5th until Superintendent Armstrong gives her recommendation to the board, the Data and Accountability team will gather and summarize public feedback. The purpose of these reports is to be open and clear. We want to share what community members have told us and explain how we will use that information. This memo shares what we have heard from our community between November 3 - 9, 2026.

Scenario Feedback Survey Findings to Date

As of November 9th, we have received 3,559 responses from parents/guardians, PPS staff, students, and community members representing all of our school communities! Responses have been collected in English, Simplified Chinese, Spanish, Vietnamese, and Russian. The survey is available in Somali, but no Somali-language responses have been collected. About 91% of respondents represented school communities affected by the rightsizing scenario proposals in some way, including school closure, school consolidation, program changes, or boundary changes. See Tables 1-3 for a breakdown of respondent demographics, and see Appendix A for counts of responses by school to date.

Table 1:
Percentage of Respondents Representing Community Roles

Community Group	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Parent/Guardian	2975	74%
Student	187	5%
Staff/Educator	338	8%
Community Member	517	13%

Table 2:
Percentage of Respondents with Students Receiving Services

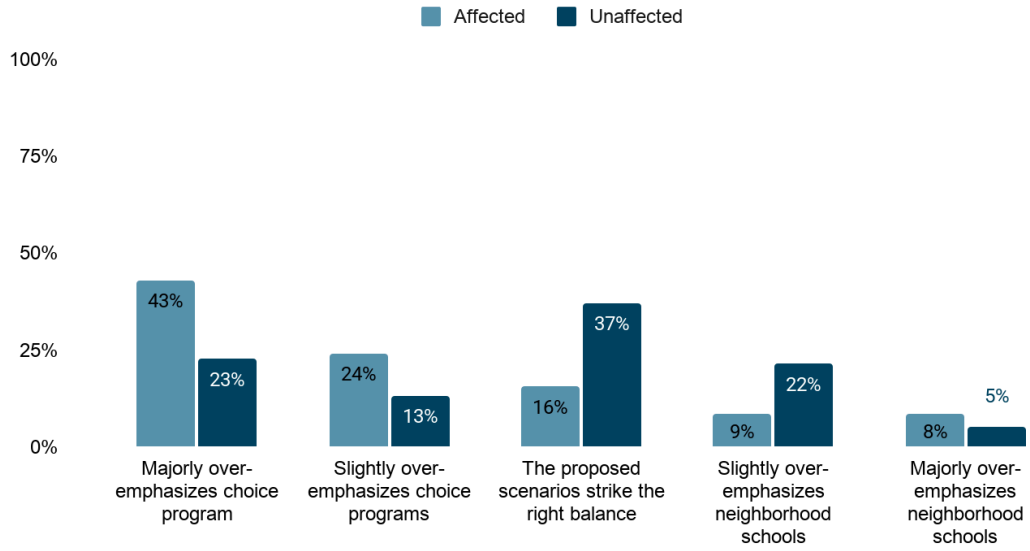
Services Received	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Special Education	710	21%
Multilingual Learner Services	56	2%
Dual Language Immersion	511	15%
Talented and Gifted	763	22%
None of the above/Prefer not to say	1402	41%

Table 3:
Percentage of Respondents by Race/Ethnicity

Race/Ethnicity of Respondents	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Asian	199	5%
Black/African American	97	3%
Latino/a/e	284	8%
American Indian/Alaskan Native	52	1%
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander	16	<1%
White	2378	63%
Multi-Racial	264	7%
Prefer Not to Say	473	13%

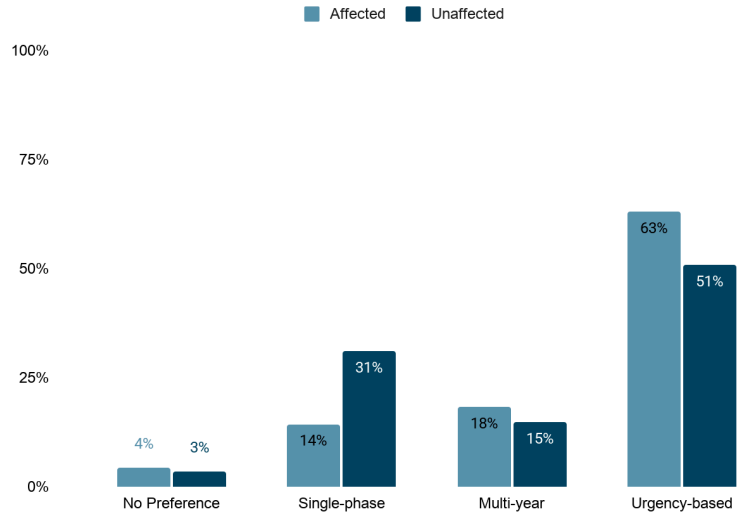
Survey Response Analysis
Below, we present the results for close-ended questions regarding rightsizing preferences, disaggregated by whether or not a respondent is directly affected by the proposed scenarios or not. Affected schools include any building facing a closure, a boundary change, or a programming change.

Resolution 7307 says that neighborhood schools are the foundation of the system when balancing access to choice programs. How well do the proposed scenarios balance those two needs? (n = 2876)



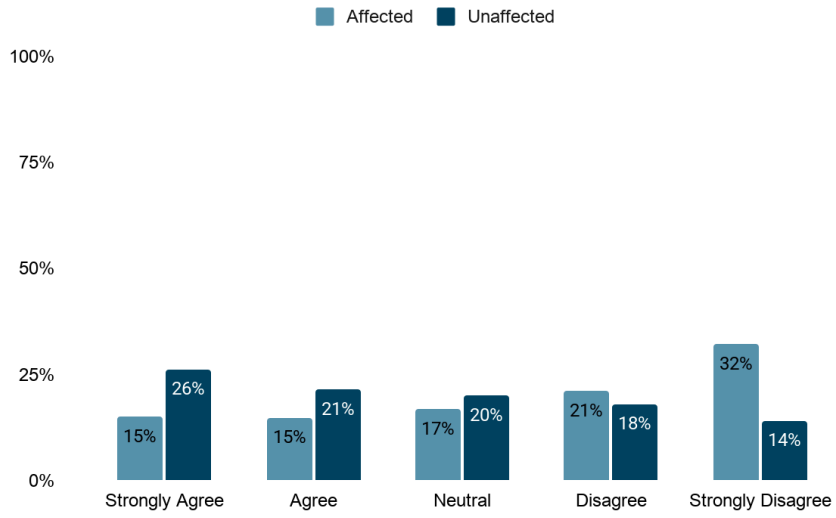
Taken together, over half of affected respondents think that the proposed scenarios over-emphasize programs of choice.

Rightsizing involves a trade-off between how large changes are and how often they occur. Which approach best aligns with your priorities? (n = 3176)



The majority of both affected and unaffected respondents urge the district to use an urgency-based approach to sequence rightsizing implementation decisions.

How much do you agree with this statement? "I am willing to accept a larger near-term adjustment (e.g., boundary change or closure) if it guarantees my school will not face further rightsizing for at least 5 years." (n = 3236)



There is no clear preference for whether respondents would prefer a larger near-term boundary change to prevent further rightsizing in Portland Public Schools.

Open-Ended Response Analysis

The survey asked the following open-ended questions:

- What specific support (e.g., transportation to school, students staying with their classmates) would you need if school changes occur all at once instead of over several years?
- What specific resources or help should the district provide to support schools affected by rightsizing?
- Our goal is to create a model that is fair and equitable to all communities. Did we miss any important equity issues, community history, or student needs in creating these models? If yes, please tell us what we missed and how we can address it.
- What is one thing you would like us to know about your school community?

This week, we are focusing our data analysis on the experiences and perspectives of receiving school stakeholders. The majority of rightsizing discussions thus far have focused on the experience of closing schools or moving programs. This week, we are pivoting to consider the experience of staff and families who are part of school communities with potentially changing boundaries to identify their needs and concerns. Below, we present the perspective of families and staff in receiving schools.

Receiving Schools Family and Community

A total of 1,245 parents/families from schools facing an attendance boundary change responded to the survey. A primary concern among receiving families centers on building capacity, facility strain, and expanding class sizes. Parents worry that absorbing students from closing schools will result in crowded classrooms and strain shared building infrastructure (e.g., cafeterias, gymnasiums, libraries, and playgrounds). Families emphasize that accepting boundary shifts must not come at the expense of higher student-to-teacher ratios or overcrowding, calling on the district to guarantee physical building upgrades and baseline staffing allocations.

Transportation logistics and student commute safety are also a major worry. Parents highlight that redrawing boundary lines forces children to travel further distances across busy thoroughfares, major traffic corridors, or unfamiliar neighborhoods. Families stress the loss of walkable neighborhood school zones and demand district-provided busing, expanded crossing guard coverage, and coordinated safe-routes-to-school infrastructure to ensure students can commute safely.

Preserving student cohorts and peer relationships is a high priority for receiving families. Respondents repeatedly request that boundary lines keep neighborhood clusters and friend groups together rather than splitting feeder patterns across different receiving schools. Parents point out that social continuity is critical for student wellbeing during major district transitions, urging PPS to align feeder pathways so that elementary student cohorts can progress into middle and high school together.

Receiving families emphasize that welcoming displaced students requires dedicated social-emotional and mental health support. Parents request that the district fund full-time counselors, social workers, and community liaison staff to help integrate new families and address transition stress. They also call for district-backed funding for joint community-building events, welcoming committees, and after-school programming (such as SUN community school programs) to foster a sense of belonging and culture-blending between existing and incoming student populations.

Receiving Schools Staff Feedback

A total of 179 staff members who reported being affiliated with proposed receiving schools responded to the survey. The primary concern for receiving school educators is operational staffing logistics. Staff want clear, early timelines for full-time equivalent allocations, unassigned staff lists, and transfer notices ahead of the end of the school year. They warn against repeating past late-spring staffing delays, which hinder master scheduling and curriculum planning. Educators also express concern over contractually mandated, seniority-based transfers, noting that shifting teachers and support staff without considering existing school cultures or programmatic needs can disrupt working environments at receiving schools.

Staff also expressed concern that expanding boundaries to absorb students from adjacent, higher-income neighborhoods would lower a receiving school's percentage of low-income students below federal funding thresholds. Staff stress that combining distinct student populations requires deliberate resources rather than assuming student bodies will integrate naturally.

Educators also reported that current special education case managers, speech-language pathologists, counselors, and behavior specialists are already operating at capacity. They emphasize that absorbing new students will significantly increase caseloads and behavioral support needs. Staff request that the district proactively allocate additional special education staff, mental health counselors, and SUN community school programming to receiving buildings before enrollment increases occur, rather than reacting after problems arise.

Finally, staffed stress that merging school communities involves far more than moving student rosters in a database. They request dedicated, district-funded time and financial resources for joint staff planning sessions, coordinated PTA transitions, and structured welcoming events for incoming families. Staff emphasize that successful school consolidation depends on proactive community-building efforts designed to help incoming students and staff feel welcomed and supported from day one.

Appendix A: Count of Responses By School as of 11/2/26

***Note**: Some respondents represent multiple school communities*

School Name	# of Responses
Abernethy E.S.	56
ACCESS K-8	61
Ainsworth E.S.	28
Alameda E.S.	52
Alliance	16
Arleta E.S.	29
Astor K-8	35
Atkinson E.S.	78
Beach E.S.	80
Beaumont M.S.	67
Benson Polytechnic H.S.	53
Beverly Cleary K-8	95
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt E.S.	20
Brentwood M.S.	31
Bridger Creative Science School	50
Bridlemile E.S.	43
Buckman E.S.	49
Capitol Hill E.S.	27
Cesar Chavez K-8	45
Chapman E.S.	14
Chief Joseph E.S.	31
Clark E.S.	44
Cleveland H.S.	295
Creston E.S.	128
DaVinci Arts M.S.	47
Dr Martin Luther King Jr E.S.	46
Duniway E.S.	177
Faubion PK-8	40

Forest Park E.S.	24
Franklin H.S.	104
George M.S.	36
Glencoe E.S.	26
Grant H.S.	179
Grout E.S.	38
Harriet Tubman M.S.	69
Harrison Park M.S.	37
Hayhurst E.S.	34
Hosford M.S.	93
Ida B Wells-Barnett H.S.	118
Irvington E.S.	120
Jackson M.S.	125
James John E.S.	260
Jefferson H.S.	48
Kellogg M.S.	42
Kelly E.S.	12
Laurelhurst K-8	177
Lent E.S.	13
Leodis V McDaniel H.S.	54
Lewis E.S.	108
Lincoln H.S.	83
Llewellyn E.S.	166
Maplewood E.S.	180
Markham E.S.	39
Marysville E.S.	46
Metropolitan Learning Center	48
Mt Tabor M.S.	41
Ockley Green M.S.	67
Odyssey Program K-8	27
Peninsula E.S.	76
Pioneer	11

Reconnection Center	7
Richmond E.S.	36
Rieke E.S.	34
Rigler E.S.	36
Robert Gray M.S.	45
Roosevelt H.S.	69
Rosa Parks E.S.	15
Rose City Park E.S.	105
Roseway Heights M.S.	55
Sabin E.S.	123
Scott E.S.	81
Sellwood M.S.	429
Sitton E.S.	90
Skyline K-8	49
Stephenson E.S.	244
Sunnyside Environmental K-8	211
Sunrise E.S.	11
Vernon K-8	78
Vestal E.S.	22
West Sylvan M.S.	40
Whitman E.S.	26
Winterhaven K-8	32
Woodlawn E.S.	16
Woodmere E.S.	47
Woodstock E.S.	61
Grand Total	**6200**